# Pol Simpson

Primary field: Environment
Secondary fields: Development, Urban

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they/them · Citizenship: UK

## Education

**The London School of Economics**, London, UK. July 2027 (expected)
MRes/PhD in Economics
Advisors: Robin Burgess, Gharad Bryan, Daniel Sturm, Oriana Bandiera

**University College London**, London, UK. 2019
MSc in Economics, with Distinction

**University of Oxford**, Oxford, UK. 2014
BA in Economics and Management, First Class

## Working papers

**Ray of Hope? China and the Rise of Solar Energy**
with Ignacio Bañares Sánchez, Robin Burgess, Dávid László, John Van Reenen and Yifan Wang
**Revise & Resubmit, The Quarterly Journal of Economics.**

## Select works in progress

**The Economic Incidence of Natural Disasters (Job Market Paper)**
with Amen Jalal

**Dynamic Costs of Resource Shocks: Evidence from Cape Town's Water Crisis**
with Emiliano Rinaldi

**Heat Insurance at Work**
with Amen Jalal, Ashley Pople, Kartik Srivastava, Eddy Zou and Oriana Bandiera

**The Fundamental Need for Shelter: Evidence from the World's Largest Home Reconstruction Program**
with Amen Jalal and Canishk Naik

## Grants

**Total funding as PI or co-PI: $770,727**

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| £190,000 | IGC | The Economic Incidence of Natural Disasters |
| £90,000 | CEPR-STEG | The Economic Incidence of Natural Disasters |
| $35,000 | Harvard University | The Economic Incidence of Natural Disasters |
| £5,000 | LSE-STICERD | The Economic Incidence of Natural Disasters |
| $264,987 | JPAL K-CAI | Heat Insurance at Work |
| $21,540 | The Weiss Fund | Heat Insurance at Work |
| £10,675 | IGC | Heat Insurance at Work |
| £22,758 | IGC | Dynamic Costs of Resource Shocks |
| $7,200 | The Weiss Fund | Dynamic Costs of Resource Shocks |

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| £5,000 | LSE-HER | The Fundamental Need for Shelter |
| £2,000 | Hayek Fund | Local Government Policy and the Spatial Concentration of Poverty |
| £2,000 | LSE-STICERD | Do Migrants Have Worse Access to Urban Amenities? |

## Presentations (* scheduled)

2026 NBER Summer Institute – Environment and Energy Economics; LSE Environment Camp; LSE Environment Week*

## Professional service

**Organizing Committee** LSE Environment Camp, Co-Chair (2023–); LSE Environment Week, Co-Chair (2022–); LSE Economics of Energy and Environment Reading Group (2021–2025); LSE QueerConf (2023–); Micro and Macro Implications of Household Finance Seminar (2021–2022)

**Committees** LSE Diversity and Inclusion Committee in Economics (2021–2023)

**Refereeing** American Economic Review; Journal of Urban Economics; European Economic Review; Economica

## Teaching

**The London School of Economics**

Lecturer, School of Public Policy:

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|---|---|---|
| Introduction to Statistics | Exec. MPA/MPP | 2022– |

Graduate Teaching Assistant, School of Public Policy:

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|---|---|---|
| Advanced Empirical Methods for Policy Analysis | MPA | 2021–2026 |
| Empirical Methods for Public Policy | Exec. MPA/MPP | 2020–2022 |
| Introduction to Statistics | Exec. MPA/MPP | 2020–2022 |

## Policy writing

Ray of Hope? The Rise of Solar Energy in China. VoxDev 2026.
How the Rural Poor Cope with a Climate Catastrophe: Evidence from Pakistan's 2022 Floods. STEG 2025.
The Impact of Flooding on Migration and Occupational Change amongst the Rural Poor: Evidence from Pakistan. IGC 2023.

## Previous employment

**Institute for Fiscal Studies**, Research Economist 2016 – 2020

**UK Government Economic Service**, Assistant Economist 2014 – 2016

## Awards

LSE Department of Economics PhD Studentship (2020–2025); Leverhulme Trade Charities Trust Graduate Bursary (2025–2027); UCL Faculty Dean's List Commendation (2019); New College (Oxford) Academic Scholarship (2012); Leverhulme Trade Charities Trust Undergraduate Bursary (2011–2014)

## References

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